left and the Hindu Mahasabha on the right, and even from some in the Congress Party.[113] But for the prime minister, an alternate approach was neither feasible nor desirable. What India lost—rights in Tibet—it could not have held on to; moreover, what India gained outweighed any loss: "a friendly frontier and an implicit acceptance of that frontier."[114] India did not have the ability to act within Tibet. It could merely tolerate, without encouraging, the Tibetan movement in India—which he assumed the US was supporting—if it was "peaceful and unobtrusive."[115] Finally, Nehru contended that "assum[ing] an aggressive role" would only lead to trouble.[116]

After the treaty was signed, Zhou Enlai suddenly accepted a pending invitation to visit India, pleasantly surprising Nehru.[117] In the US, a *New York Times* editorial reflected American disapproval, noting with chagrin that Zhou's visit was taking place on the fourth anniversary of the Chinese-"aided and abetted" North Korean invasion of South Korea.[118] In India, Zhou was well received. Nehru and the premier did not discuss potentially contentious issues like the Sino-Indian border—Nehru indeed thought that the very act of bringing the subject up might suggest doubt about India's frontiers, which he asserted were settled.[119] Sarvepalli (S.) Radhakrishnan, the Indian vice president, told Allen that Zhou was reasonable about every subject, except one—the US.[120]

US policy toward China was a key subject in the Sino-Indian discussions, and their different perceptions of and policies toward the US were evident. The Chinese premier wanted China and India to use the Panchsheel principles jointly to help stop the spread of the US military bloc in Asia. But, while highly critical of US policy toward China in internal correspondence, Nehru was more circumspect in conversations with Zhou. He admitted that US-India relations were "not good," but declined Zhou's suggestion that China and India try to corner or isolate the US. Furthermore, Nehru tried to explain the motivation behind US policy toward China, stating that it partly stemmed from domestic politics. He noted, moreover, "the vicious circle of fear"—acting out of fear, the US was encircling and, in turn, creating fear in China and the Soviet Union.[121]

In order not to exacerbate American anxieties or further harm US-India relations, Nehru ensured that the Sino-Indian joint statement emerging from the visit did not condemn the US or any other country. Furthermore, as in